



DECODING STRATEGIES (From left) Siddharth Zarabi, Editor, *Business Today*; Vinay Dube, Founder & CEO, Akasa Air; and Sanjeev Krishnan, Chairperson, PwC in India, during the inaugural *Business Today* MindRush PODS

for the aviation sector. As India becomes more aspirational, a lot of that will mean that a lot of Indians are flying. I completely agree with the comparison that Vinay made in terms of per capita utilisation with the US. India has a lot to achieve. I believe that in the next 20 years... Indian consumerism will rise and there will be significant opportunities for businesses like aviation.

SZ: The price difference between an air ticket and a first-class train ticket has come down significantly... Is that the future of aviation pricing?

VD: Hats off to the Indian airlines for being one of the most efficient in the world! If you look at the cost structure that we have created in India, it is on par or better than some of the finest airlines in any other part of the world... And this happens because we've got some of the finest aviation lines in this country creating cost structures that are as affordable.

“Never in the history of Indian aviation has an airline launched an international sector within 18 months [of starting operations]... There was very specific policy change that enabled that”

I think you're going to see growth, but you're going to see stability in aviation as you have a different genre of airlines today. You have airlines that are professionally managed... airlines that are well capitalised. Today, airlines don't have the cost structure